

Cambodia



Area 69,900 sq miles
(181,040 sq km)
Population 14.3 million
Capital Phnom Penh
Currency Riel
Official language Khmer
Life expectancy 59 years



Cambodia emerged from French colonial rule in 1953. From 1975 to 1979, the extremist Khmer Rouge regime headed by Pol Pot was responsible for killing almost a million Cambodians. Today, Cambodia is one of the world's poorest countries and relies heavily on foreign aid.

Singapore



Area 250 sq miles
(648 sq km)
Population 5.2 million
Capital Singapore
Currency Singapore dollar
Official languages Malay, English, Mandarin, and Tamil
Life expectancy 80 years



An island nation, Singapore (meaning "lion city") was once a trading post of colonial Britain. Today, it is a wealthy nation known for its electronics and pharmaceutical industries, and its skilled workforce. The people of Singapore enjoy one of the world's highest standards of living.

East Timor



Area 5,742 sq miles
(14,874 sq km)
Population 1.2 million
Capital Dili
Currency US dollar
Official languages Tetum and Portuguese
Life expectancy 57 years



East Timor achieved its independence in 2002 after a long and turbulent struggle against Indonesian occupation. Much of its infrastructure was destroyed during the violence, and the government heavily depends on foreign aid, especially from Australia and Portugal. Oil and gas from the Timor Sea forms its main source of income.



▲ MALAYSIAN TEXTILES

Textiles and clothing are one of Malaysia's main exports and the industry has contributed to the country's economic growth.

Brunei



Area 2,228 sq miles
(5,770 sq km)
Population 400,000
Capital Bandar Seri Begawan
Currency Brunei dollar
Official language Malay
Life expectancy 77 years



Lying on the island of Borneo, the Sultanate of Brunei is divided in two by a strip of the Malaysian state of Sarawak. Independent from the UK since 1984, Brunei is ruled by decree of the sultan. Oil and gas revenue has made Brunei a wealthy nation with very high standards of living.

Indonesia



Area 740,100 sq miles
(1,919,440 sq km)
Population 242 million
Capital Jakarta
Currency Rupiah
Official language Bahasa Indonesia
Life expectancy 68 years



Indonesia is the world's largest archipelago. Its 18,108 islands stretch 3,100 miles (5,000 km) from the Indian Ocean to New Guinea. Some islands, such as Java, Sumatra, Kalimantan, and Papua, are mountainous, volcanic, and densely forested. Indonesia is ethnically very diverse and has the world's largest Muslim population.

Malaysia



Area 127,317 sq miles
(329,750 sq km)
Population 28.9 million
Capital Kuala Lumpur, Putrajaya (administrative)
Currency Ringgit
Official language Bahasa Malaysia
Life expectancy 74 years



Malaysia consists of the three territories of Peninsular Malaysia, Sarawak, and Sabah. Ethnic Malays make up about half the population, with a large Chinese minority. Malaysia's scenic beaches make it a key tourist destination in Southeast Asia.

Philippines



Area 115,830 sq miles
(300,000 sq km)
Population 94.9 million
Capital Manila
Currency Philippine peso
Official languages English and Filipino
Life expectancy 71 years



Lying on the western rim of the Pacific Ocean, the Philippines is the world's second largest archipelago nation. Its three main island groupings are Luzon, Visayan, and the Mindanao and Sulu islands. Of the 7,107 islands, only 1,000 are inhabited. The islands are prone to frequent earthquakes.



▲ ORANGUTAN, SUMATRA

The endangered Sumatran orangutan is found only on the island of Sumatra, Indonesia, and lives mainly on a diet of fruit.

